4. "*The Spider turned him round about, and went into his den,*
For well he knew the silly Fly would soon come back again:"

a) Why is the poet using the word '**den**' to describe the spider's web?

b) Why was the spider sure that the fly would come back again?

5. "*With buzzy wings she hung aloft, then near and nearer drew,*
Thinking only of her brilliant eyes, and green and purple hue —"

a) Who does 'she' refer to?

b) What was 'she' thinking of?

6. "*And now dear little children, who may this story read,*
To idle, silly flattering words, I pray you ne'er give heed:"

a) Who does 'I' refer to?

b) What is the advice given to the readers?

B. Complete the summary by filling in the spaces with suitable words.

The poem begins with the spider's_____ of the fly. He _____ to the fly to come into its home. The spider describes his parlour as the _____ one. The spider kindles the curiosity of the fly so that she may enter his home. Fortunately, the fly was _____ and refused to get into his home. Now the spider pretends to be a _____and asks her to come and rest in his home. He offers her _____ and a _____ to rest. This time also the fly _____ the spider's offer very politely. The next weapon that the spider uses is_____. The spider praises the _____ and _____of the fly and also praises her _____. He invites her to look at herself in the _____which is in his parlour. The fly is_____ by the words of the spider and she falls a _____ to his _____.

C. Answer the following questions in about 80-100 words.

1. Write a character sketch of the spider.
2. What happens if we fall a prey to flattery? Give instances from the poem 'The Spider and the Fly'.
3. In your own words give a detailed description of:

   a) The Spider's Parlour

   b) The Fly's Appearance

Appreciate the poem



Anthropomorphism means to endow a non-human character with human traits and behaviour. For example: Throughout the poem, we see the spider and the fly behave like human beings. We see a pantry, bed, mirror, and stairs and so on.

9th English Unit 4 PR PO Supple Pages 088-116.indd 105 28-11-2022 17:27:25